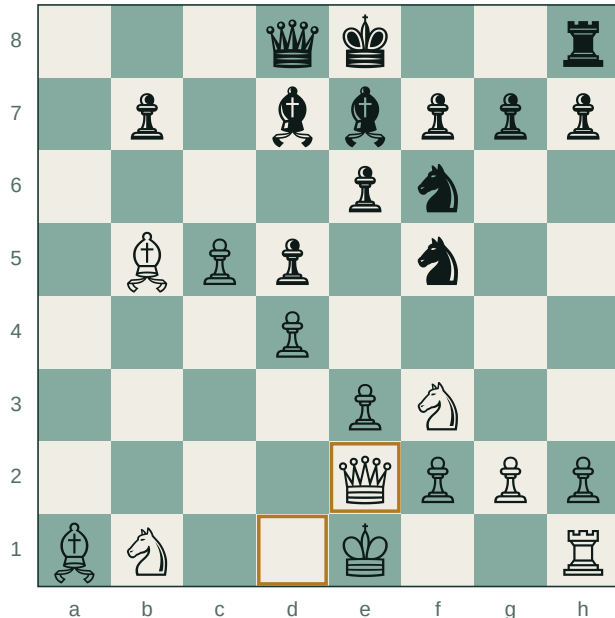


Forks and double attacks: Black, move 15

Forks and double attacks

Black to move



Previous move: 15.Qe2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

15...Qa5+ 16. Bc3 Qxb5

15...Qa5+ Check restricts White to 7 legal replies here. From a5 it attacks king on e1, bishop on b5 and bishop on a1. Recorded reply: **16.Bc3**.

16...Qxb5 The queen captures the bishop on b5. From b5 it attacks queen on e2 and knight on b1.

At the end, nominal material is White 29 / Black 32 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +3. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer: +3:** the balance goes from +0 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Two attacked pieces do not guarantee a gain if the forking piece can be captured or one target moves with check.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A fork attacks multiple targets at once. The combination works when the defender cannot save everything or generate a stronger forcing reply.

HOW TO LOOK

Look for checking forks first, then double attacks on queens, rooks, and undefended pieces. Follow the line until the material is actually collected.

The defending king is on e1. Geometrically undefended: rook on h1 and knight on b1. Check for tactical protection.